KEEPER OF THE FLAME

For the MIAs of this war and all the wars . . . lest we forget . . .

The book of your memory is shrouded in black
For a son gone to war who would never come back.
And you would smile out at her, down through the years,
From that book full of photographs, pasted with tears,
For she would look through them again and again
Her gnarled hands caressing each frame
While she grieved there'd be no one to cherish your life
Since no son would carry your name.
And now she is gone
But she need not have feared
For I am your chosen rememberer, dear.

1991 Honorable Mention, Carl Stiefel Award
for National or World Events